Redez

Fortified Home Redesignation

Purpose: To verify existing FORTIFIED homes meet current program requirements and document any changes made for continued compliance.

Scope: Applies to homes undergoing renewal where no full roof replacement has occurred or no changes have been made to current homeowners knowledge.

Required Tools:

- Smartphone/tablet with CompanyCam and Service Fusion
- Tape measure
- Ladder
- Checklist
- Receipt Book
- Business cards

Preparation Before Evaluation:

- Review notes in service fusion for appointment time, access, payment, etc.
- Contact the homeowner if requested for inspection.
- Ensure you have: Wifi/cell data access, proper access to apps, phone fully charged

Step-by-Step Procedure:

On Arrival

1. Verify the correct address and match what we have on file.
2. Follow CompanyCam procedures, open correct project and complete checklist
3. Greet homeowner, explain the purpose of the visit.
4. Get permission to access any areas needed to complete renewal; attic, garage, and property exterior.
5. If the homeowner is not present, call the homeowner to get permission to access property.

6. Leave a door hanger if no one is on site and you are not able to contact the homeowner.

Exterior Inspection:

7. Inspect and photograph:
    - All exterior elevations of the home (front, back, left and right)
    - Windows and doors (verify with HO if changes have been made)
    - Garage doors (verify with HO if changes have been made)
    - Attached structures (verify if new, verify connections to main home)
    - All roof lines (confirm no major repairs or patches, no damage at time of visit)

Documentation & Submission

- Use the appropriate checklist (take photo of completed checklist)
- Ensure all photos are clear, site specific and visible
- Note any changes or deficiencies and notify QA team
- Thoroughly document any changes made
- Change sub status in service fusion to prompt next steps
- Add any notes for that job visit

1. **Verify Site-Specific Notes & Greet the Homeowner**
    - Review job notes before arriving (access, payment, time-frame). Let the homeowner know you're performing an exterior-only FORTIFIED renewal inspection
2. **Photograph the Roof**
    - Get clear photos of all roof slopes, including vents
3. **Photograph All Exterior Doors (GOLD)**
    - Include front, side, back and any other entry doors
4. **Photograph All Windows (GOLD)**
    - Walk the exterior and get clear photos of every window
5. **Photograph the Garage Door (GOLD)**
    - Capture a full view of the garage door closed
6. **Inspect Attached Structures**
    - Document porches, carports, or other attached structures (close-up of how attached to house/overview of location)
7. **Collect Payment & Submit Job**
    - Finish checklist
    - Verify any changes with homeowner
    - Make adequate notes
    - Notify QA team about changes
    - Payment is due before submission - collect at time of visit if able (make note of payment/receipt given)
    - Politely ask for a review: "If you are happy with the service today, feel free to scan this and leave a review – it helps us out a lot!"
    - Change sub-status: Ready To Submit
8. **Review Job**
    - Make sure to review all items before leaving the job to limit mistakes and the amount of revisits required.

Final Evaluation

Fortified Final Evaluation

Purpose: To gather final documentation of the roof installation and verify that nothing will delay certification.

Scope: Applies to Final Evaluations after roof installation, including documentation of required construction elements, compliance checks and photo evidence.

Required Tools:

- Smartphone with FortiForms, CompanyCam and Service Fusion
- Ladder
- Tape measure
- Metal Detector
- Pitch Gauge
- Cards to measure roof deck thickness
- Flashlight
- Receipt Book

Preparation Before Inspection:

- Review notes in service fusion for appointment time, access, payment, etc.
- Contact the homeowner before arriving if requested for inspection.
- Ensure you have: Wifi/cell data access, proper access to apps, phone fully charged

Step-by-Step Procedure:

On Arrival

1. Verify the correct address and match what we have on file
2. Follow FortiForms procedures, create project and use checklist
3. Greet homeowner, explain the purpose of the visit.
4. Get permission to access any areas needed to complete evaluation; attic, garage, and property exterior. (If any access is not available contact QA team)

Exterior Inspection:

5. Inspect and photograph:
    - All exterior elevations of the home (front, back, left and right)
    - All roof slopes (pay close attention to different roof slopes)
    - Roof vents (ridge vent, off-ridge vent)
    - Foundation
    - Attached structures (verify if new, verify connections to main home)

Attic Inspection

6. Document:
    - (1) Ring shank nail (find ONE missed nail and measure)
    - (1) Roof deck thickness (stamp or plywood seam measured)
    - (6) Nail-off (verify deck nailing at 4” o.c. over a 4 ft span)
    - Gable vents (take photo of all gable walls if accessible)
    - Rafter Spacing (3 rafters visible to verify spacing)
    - Pitch (all roof slopes)

7. Confirm Details & Collect Payment
    - Inform HO that payment is due before submission for certification
    - Certification can take up to 3 weeks after submission
    - Collect payment via cash, check or card
    - Document and make note of any payments received at the job
    - Leave receipt if paying with cash or check
    - Ensure HO is aware of Fortified process and doesn’t have any questions
    - Practice exceptional customer service

Documentation & Submission

- Use the appropriate form in FortiForms
- Ensure all photos are clear, site specific and visible
- Note any changes or deficiencies and notify QA team
- Thoroughly document any issues or concerns
- Change sub status in service fusion to prompt next steps

1. Review Site Specific Notes
    - Review job notes before arriving (access, payment, time-frame)
2. Greet Homeowner
    - Let the homeowner know you are performing a Fortified Evaluation to provide certification for the home. You will need access to the property exterior and attic access.
3. Follow Checklist
    - Use appropriate checklist; photograph all items and make sure to complete checklist
4. Collect Payment & Complete Job
    - Ensure HO is aware of Fortified and doesn't have any questions
    - Payment is due before submission - collect at time of visit if able (make note of payment/receipt given)
    - Practice exceptional customer service
    - Politely ask for a review: "If you are happy with the service today, feel free to scan this and leave a review – it helps us out a lot!"
    - Notify QA team of any concerns
    - Change sub-status: Ready To Submit
5. Review Job
    - Make sure to review all items before leaving the job to limit mistakes and the amount of revisits required.

Fortified New Start

Fortified New Start

Purpose: To verify and document key elements of a FORTIFIED Roof installation in progress, including deck attachment, sealed roof deck, and roof covering materials — especially those that will be covered up by the time of the Final Evaluation.

Video Walkthrough: **New Start 1/3** **New Start 2/3** **New Start 3/3**

When It Happens

During the roof installation – usually after tear-off, while:

- Decking is exposed
- Nailing and sealing are in progress
- Roofing underlayment, drip edge, shingles and starter may or may not be installed yet

Required Tools:

- Smartphone with FortiForms, CompanyCam and Service Fusion
- Ladder
- Tape Measure
- Flashlight/headlamp
- Pitch gauge
- Metal Detector
- Business cards to measure thickness
- Roofer Post Cards/Checklists

Step-by-Step Field Process

Step 1: Review Job Details

- Confirm project info, address, contractor
- Review any notes about site visit
- Follow FortiForms procedures, create project and complete form.

Step 2: Greet Roofer or Homeowner

- Let the crew know you're doing the in-progress FORTIFIED evaluation
- Verify if anything needs to be addressed with on site personnel
- Ensure roofer is taking photo documentation of install and communicate that Knockout will not be able to stay on site for the length of the install

Step 3: Document Decking & Attachment

- Take photos of:
    - Exposed roof decking
    - Nailing pattern (nail type, spacing, edge distance)
    - Deck condition (no major rot, gaps, delamination)
    - Any deck repairs or replacements
    - Roof deck thickness (stamp, edge measurement)

- Get close-ups of fasteners and overall deck layout

Step 4: Verify Sealed Roof Deck Method

- Confirm which method is being used:
    - Tape over seams
    - Full peel-and-stick underlayment
    - Double layer synthetic
- Photograph materials, labels, and application in progress
- Capture wide shots and close-ups of installation

Step 5: Document Additional Components

- Roof vents, boots, flashing
- Drip edge (if already installed on eaves or rakes)
- Starter strip and underlayment, if started
- Any attached structures

Step 6: Optional – Attic Access

- If attic is accessible and safe to enter:
    - Photograph deck nail-off
    - Roof deck thickness
    - Ring shank nail
    - Pitch
    - Rafter spacing

Step 7: Checklist & Wrap-Up

- Complete New Start checklist
- Leave notes for office if:
    - Part of roof is already covered
    - Roof install not in progress or no materials on site
    - Issues or concerns of compliance
    - Verify foundation, attached structures, roof deck thickness and materials are all compliant with Fortified standards.
- Let roofer know you're done and thank them

Using FortiForms

SOP: Using FortiForms for Job Documentation

Purpose

To ensure all evaluations are documented consistently, accurately, and in compliance with Knockout and IBHS requirements using FortiForms.

Scope

This SOP applies to all evaluators and team members required to complete job documentation using FortiForms for any job type.

Responsibility

- **Evaluators:** Responsible for completing the correct FortiForm in full and ensuring all required fields are completed prior to submission.
- **Management / QA:** Responsible for reviewing submitted forms for completeness and accuracy.

Procedure

1. Sign In

1. Open FortiForms on your mobile device or tablet.
2. Log in using your assigned username and password.
3. Confirm you are logged into the correct company/workspace.

2. Select the Appropriate Form

1. From the form list, select the **correct form based on the job type** you are completing (example: Home Assessment, Re-Designation, Final Evaluation, Energy Testing, etc.).
2. Verify the form name matches the scope of work before proceeding.

Important: Selecting the wrong form may result in job delays, rework, or rejection.

3. Complete the Form in Full

1. Read each question carefully before answering.
2. Complete **all required fields**, including:
    - Job and property information
    - Required photos
    - Measurements and observations
    - Notes and comments where applicable
3. Upload clear, well-lit photos that meet Knockout and IBHS documentation standards.
4. Ensure all answers are accurate and reflect site conditions.

Note: FortiForms will not allow submission if required fields are incomplete.

4. Review Before Submission

1. Scroll through the entire form before submitting.
2. Confirm:
    - No required fields are missing
    - Photos are attached and legible
    - Notes are complete and clear
3. Correct any errors or omissions before proceeding.

5. Submit the Form

1. Once all required fields are completed, select **Submit**.
2. Wait for confirmation that the form has been successfully submitted.
3. Do not exit or close the app until submission is confirmed.

Submission Requirements

- Forms **must be fully completed** to be submitted.
- Partial, incomplete, or inaccurate forms will be rejected and returned for correction.
- Failure to follow this SOP may result in delays, reduced compensation, or retraining requirements.

Best Practices

- Complete the form **on-site**.

- Upload photos as you go to avoid missing documentation.
- If unsure which form to use, contact management **before** starting the form.

Revision & Training

- All evaluators must review this SOP during onboarding.
- Updates will be communicated as FortiForms or internal requirements change.

Compliance with this SOP is mandatory for all FortiForms submissions.

Field Customer Service

Field Customer Service

Purpose: To provide consistent guidelines for employees visiting homeowner properties, ensuring professional behavior, appearance, and communication that represents the company positively.

Scope: Applies to all employees performing on-site inspections, evaluations, or appointments at homeowner properties.

Required Tools:

- Company-branded clothing or uniform
- Business cards
- Phone/tablet with FortiForms, CompanyCam and Service Fusion
- Safety gear, if applicable
- Checklist or forms for the appointment

Procedure

1. Preparation Before Visit

1. Review appointment details in Service Fusion: time, address, homeowner notes, and access instructions.
2. Ensure all required tools, checklists, and safety gear are ready.
3. Confirm your uniform is clean, professional, and follows the company dress code.
4. Ensure your phone/tablet is charged and apps (FortiForms, CompanyCam, Service Fusion) are functioning.
5. Plan your arrival to be punctual; consider travel time and traffic.

2. Arrival at Property

1. Park safely and avoid blocking neighbors' driveways or sidewalks.
2. Approach the home confidently, keeping tools and equipment organized.
3. Observe surroundings for pets, children, or hazards before approaching the door.
4. Knock or ring the doorbell politely (once or twice) and step back.
5. Smile and maintain professional body language while waiting for the homeowner to answer.

3. Greeting the Homeowner

1. Introduce yourself with your name and company.
2. Clearly and politely explain the purpose of your visit.
3. Use a friendly, professional tone and maintain eye contact.
4. Provide a business card if appropriate.
5. Acknowledge the homeowner's concerns or frustration, if present, and remain calm.

4. On-Site Professionalism

1. Maintain professional posture, body language, and tone throughout the visit.
2. Handle pets, children, or distractions politely and keep focus on the task.
3. Keep your tools, ladder, and workspace organized and safe.
4. If access to a certain area is denied, politely explain the reason and document the refusal.
5. Do not engage in personal discussions outside the purpose of the visit; redirect respectfully.

5. Communication and Problem-Solving

1. Explain each step of the inspection or appointment clearly and concisely.
2. Listen actively to homeowner questions and acknowledge their concerns.
3. If a request is outside the scope of the visit, explain this politely and provide next steps or contact information.

6. Departure

1. Thank the homeowner for their time and cooperation.
2. Ensure the site is left neat and all tools/equipment are removed.
3. Confirm any follow-up actions are clearly documented in Service Fusion or relevant software.
4. Update the status of the visit in Service Fusion to prompt next steps.

7. Key Guidelines

- Always wear a professional, company-approved uniform.
  Maintain friendly, courteous, and professional behavior at all times.
- Focus on the purpose of the visit; avoid personal conversations unrelated to the inspection.
- Keep documentation clear, accurate, and complete.

- Use scenario judgment when unexpected issues arise, following company policy.

Payments

Receiving Payments in the Field

Purpose: To ensure field technicians properly collect and report payments at the time of service using one of three approved methods: **cash**, **check**, or **card payment over the phone via the office**.

Scope: Applies to **all field techs** collecting payment during onsite visits (Redesignation, New Start, Final Evaluations, etc.).

Payment Methods Accepted

1. **Cash**
2. **Check** (Made payable to *Knockout Inspections*)
3. **Card payment by phone** (Customer calls the office OR tech does on their behalf)

Step-by-Step Field Process

Step 1: Confirm Payment is Due

- Check your schedule notes or job details before arrival.
- If unsure, contact the office before asking the client.

Step 2: Politely Request Payment

After the inspection is complete, say:

> "Payment is due today — we accept cash, check, or I can call the office and they'll take your card over the phone."

Step 3: Accept Payment

Cash

- Count and confirm the amount with the client

- Take a photo of the cash in hand
- Provide receipt to HO and keep copy to turn into the office
- Note the amount in the job record
- Turn in cash to the office same day

Check

- Ensure it's made out to **Knockout Inspections**
- Write the **check number** in the notes
- Provide receipt to HO and keep copy to turn into the office
- Take a photo of the check (front only)
- Turn in check to office same day

Card by Phone

- Call the office with the client present
- Let the client speak to the office directly or pass along card info
- Wait to confirm payment was processed
- Ask the office to email or text a receipt to the client

Step 4: Confirm & Record Payment

- Make a note in the job record:
    - Payment type
    - Amount
    - Who paid (if not the homeowner)
- Let the office know if anything was unusual (partial payment, delay, etc.)

Step 5: Thank the Client & Wrap Up

Say:

> "Thanks again — you're all set. We'll finish up everything on our end and follow up if needed."
> Complete your photo checklist and mark the job as complete.

Reminders

- Cash and checks are required to be dropped off same day or within 24 hours
- Never leave a job without confirming payment or calling the office
- Stay professional — offer all 3 options clearly

- If customer refuses to pay or delays:
    - **Don’t argue**
    - **Notify the office immediately**

SAH Assessment

Strengthen Alabama Home Pre-Evaluation

Purpose: To perform a detailed **pre-evaluation** of a home applying for the **Strengthen Alabama Homes $10,000 grant**, verifying whether it meets key FORTIFIED Roof™ structural requirements — or what retrofits are needed to bring it into compliance.

Scope: This process applies to **all technicians** performing SAH grant-related evaluations. It includes both interior (attic) and exterior observations and documentation.

Tools Needed

- Smartphone/tablet with companycam
- Iform App
- SAH Assessment Form
- PPE
- Ladder
- Tape measure
- Flashlight or headlamp
- Business cards to measure deck thickness
- Receipt book

Step-by-Step Field Process

Step 1: Prep & Review

- Confirm homeowner's participation in **SAH program**
- Verify that **pre-evaluation** is for **eligibility**
- Review job notes
- Upload checklist to complete job

Step 2: Greet Homeowner & Explain Visit

Say something like:

> "I'm here today to assess your home for the Strengthen Alabama Homes program. I'll check inside the attic and around the exterior to see what's needed to meet FORTIFIED Roof standards and qualify you for the grant."

Let the homeowner know:

- You'll need access to attic
- This is not a guarantee of grant approval — it's a **structural evaluation**

Step 3: Exterior Documentation

Photograph and assess:

- Roof slope
- Attached structures
- Exterior elevation
- Gable vents
- Condition of soffits and overhangs

Step 4: Attic Inspection

If accessible, document:

- Roof deck type (OSB, plywood, plank)
- Roof deck thickness
- Truss or rafter spacing
- Look for visible deck sealing issues, damage, or prior retrofits
- Document any attic accessibility issues

Step 5: Identify Deficiencies / Retrofit Needs

Note any areas that **do not meet** FORTIFIED standards:

- No access to verify components
- Damaged fascia and/or soffit
- Rafter spacing greater than 24" o.c.
- Roof deck thickness ⅜"
- Dry stack foundation
- Gable vents open and need to be covered
- 1x Decking

Step 6: Complete Checklist & Notes

- Attach appropriate checklist to job and ensure all items are checked off

- Take all photos in companycam as well to ensure back up documentation
- Add field notes on any observed retrofit needs

Step 7: Submit & Notify Office

- Collect payment, get form signed and inform HO to check online portal within next 5 business days for next steps
- Sync CompanyCam photos and IFORM
- Add notes to project file
- Notify office if:
    - Attic was not accessible
    - A specific retrofit is recommended
    - Any photos are missing due to site conditions

Key Reminders

- You are helping the homeowner **qualify** — accuracy matters
- Be friendly but avoid promising approval
- Always document **why** something can't be verified (e.g., no attic access)
- If unsure about a structural element, **take extra photos** and ask office

Dress Code

Dress for Success

Purpose

To ensure all team members present a professional, consistent, and trustworthy appearance that reflects the company's standards, values, and commitment to quality service—while allowing practical flexibility for labor-intensive tasks.

Scope

This SOP applies to all field staff during:

- Work hours
- Customer-facing activities
- Job sites
- Meetings
- Company events where representing the company

Required Attire (Standard Uniform)

Primary Work Attire

- Company-issued polo must be worn for:
    - Customer interactions
    - Walkthroughs
    - Inspections
    - Meetings
- Shirt must be:
    - Clean
    - Free of stains, rips, or excessive fading
    - Tucked in at all times when worn

Approved Alternative for Labor-Intensive Tasks

- Team members may keep a company-issued t-shirt in their vehicle
- The company t-shirt may be worn only during labor-intensive or physically demanding tasks
- Conditions:
    - Shirt must be company-branded

        - Clean and in good condition
        - Used strictly for the duration of the labor-intensive task

The company polo must be put back on before:

- Customer communication
- Walkthroughs
- Leaving the job site
- Any customer-facing interaction

Pants / Shorts

- Acceptable options:
    - Jeans
    - Khakis
    - Work shorts
- Requirements:
    - No holes, tears, or fraying
    - Proper fit (not sagging or excessively baggy)
    - Neutral, professional appearance

Belt

- Belt is required
- Must be worn properly

Footwear

- Closed-toe shoes required at all times
- Must be:
    - In good condition
    - Appropriate for job site conditions and safety

General Appearance Standards

- Clothing must be clean, neat, and professional
- Personal hygiene must be maintained
- No offensive graphics or non-company logos visible
- Hats (if worn):
    - Company-branded preferred
    - Forward-facing only

Prohibited Attire

- Non-company shirts while on the job
- Untucked polos
- Clothing with holes, stains, or excessive wear
- Athletic wear, gym shorts, sweatpants
- Flip-flops, slides, or open-toe shoes

Accountability & Enforcement

- This SOP is mandatory
- Failure to comply may result in:
    - Immediate correction
    - Being sent home to change
    - Disciplinary action for repeated non-compliance

Consistent compliance may be considered in:

- Performance reviews
- Incentive eligibility
- Team recognition programs

Expectation Statement

We dress professionally because:

- Customers trust teams that look professional
- Our appearance reflects the quality of our work
- We represent the company, our teammates, and ourselves

Dress for success. Be ready for work. Represent the brand well.

Free Time

Field Technician Downtime Expectations

Purpose: To guide field technicians on how to use their time effectively and responsibly when not actively assigned to a job site or evaluation. This process ensures downtime is used to support the team, improve skills, and stay ready for the next assignment.

Scope: Applies to all field staff when there are **gaps between appointments**, **schedule delays**, **job cancellations**, or **early job completions**.

Step-by-Step Expectations for Downtime

1. Check In with the Office

- Let the office know you're clear from your last job:
- Ask if there are any:
    - Last-minute jobs
    - Nearby site checks or photo retakes

2. Complete Admin Tasks

Use this time to wrap up anything pending:

- Finish and upload any **checklists/photos**
- Label any **missing or unclear photos**
- Submit any handwritten notes or forms
- Double-check **photo quality and clarity**
- Drop off any cash or check payments to the office

3. Vehicle & Equipment Check

Keep your rig in top shape:

- Clean out and organize the truck
- Check on any vehicle maintenance
- Check ladders, gear, PPE, battery levels, etc.
- Restock materials (checklists, cards, markers, yard signs, etc.)

4. Training & Skill Building

Use spare time for light professional development:

- Review Knockout SOPs
- Watch internal training videos or FORTIFIED training
- Shadow a senior tech if one is nearby
- Ask for guidance on what training should be completed
- Take initiative to learn other internal skills for Knockout

5. Proactive Value-Adds

Think ahead and support the team:

- Drive by a site for progress photos (if needed)
- Help another tech nearby if requested
- Visit real estate, insurance, roofers and HVAC companies (if permitted)
- Place Knockout yard signs at GOLD projects or around neighborhoods with past Fortified jobs

6. Always Stay Available

Keep your phone on and volume up!

- Be ready to take a call or reassignment
- Do not assume the day is done unless told

Reminders

- Downtime is still on-the-clock — it's not break time unless approved
- Taking initiative during slow times shows leadership
- If you're out of ideas, call the office — they'll appreciate it

Rain Delays

Weather Interruptions

Purpose: To guide technicians on how to proceed when weather interrupts scheduled site visits. This ensures **safety**, clear **communication**, and responsible use of **unassigned time**.

Scope: This applies when field techs encounter **rain**, **severe weather**, or **unsafe travel conditions** during the workday that may impact job safety or schedule.

Step-by-Step Process

1. Evaluate Conditions on Site

If weather begins or is ongoing:

- Assess roof and ladder safety
- **Do not access roofs or attics if unsafe**
- Check visibility and wind before starting exterior photo work

2. Proceed with What Can Be Done Safely

FORTIFIED Final Evaluations, Redesignations and BLDs

- Complete:
    - Attic access (if safe and dry)
    - Garage and exterior door checks
    - Exterior photos (if not raining heavily)
- Skip unsafe areas and **document what's missing clearly**
- Notify the office immediately

FORTIFIED New Starts

- Typically rescheduled if roofing isn't in progress

- **Contact the roofer** directly:
  "Are y'all still planning to roof today, or has the job been moved to a different day?"
- Relay info to the office

3. If Driving Conditions Feel Unsafe

- If **you do not feel safe driving** due to rain, wind, or road conditions:
  - **Find a safe place nearby to pull off** (gas station, parking lot, etc.)
  - Use your phone to **check radar or weather app** for:
    - Severity of the storm
    - How long it's expected to last
  - Notify the office or supervisor:
    "I'm pulled over due to weather near [location]. I'll wait it out and update you shortly."

4. For Severe Weather or Active Storms

- If thunder, lightning, high wind, or local warnings are in effect:
  - **Contact your supervisor** for instructions
  - Do **not** make judgment calls about canceling
  - Wait for office direction before leaving area or rescheduling anything

5. Follow Downtime SOP (If Delayed or Waiting)

If the weather prevents safe work or travel:

- Begin **Downtime SOP tasks**:
  - Finalize any open jobs or checklists
  - Organize and label photos
  - Place Knockout yard signs (if safe and dry)
  - Help another tech nearby
  - Contact the office for extra tasks

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6. Document the Weather Conditions

- Take a photo of wet roof or rain on windshield

- Make notes in ServiceFusion of the weather delay
- Note which work was completed and what was delayed

Reminders

- Never pressure yourself to drive or climb in unsafe conditions
- Employee safety is more important than the schedule
- Clear communication and documentation protect you and the company
- If unsure, call the office or your supervisor

Blower Door Test

Blower Door Testing

Purpose: To accurately measure the air leakage rate (ACH50) of a home or building using a calibrated blower door, in compliance with energy code, or program-specific standards.

Applies To: All field technicians performing blower door tests

1. Preparation Before the Job

Equipment Checklist

- Blower door frame and fan
- Digital manometer
- Speed controller
- Tubing set
- Fan flow rings
- Power cords
- Tape

Pre-Visit Tasks

- Confirm test address and appointment time
- Review requirements (Energy Code, EnergySTAR)
- Confirm square footage and ceiling heights to calculate volume on site
- Ensure the building is ready:
    - All exterior doors/windows installed
    - Weatherstripping installed
    - Insulation in place
    - HVAC ducts/grilles installed
    - No open holes to outside

2. On-Site Testing Procedure

Initial Walkthrough

- Greet client or supervisor
- Ask if any combustion appliances are present (fireplace, water heater, furnace)
- Turn off all combustion appliances and HVAC system
- Make sure all bath fans, kitchen exhaust fans and dryer are turned off
- Close all exterior doors and windows
- Open all interior doors (except to unconditioned areas)
- If there is a vented fireplace, make sure damper is closed

Setup Blower Door

- Select an exterior door
- Install the blower door frame and panel securely
- Mount the fan and connect tubing:
    - Green tube to outside
    - Red tube to fan pressure tap
- Plug in fan and connect manometer
- Ensure the fan is baselined before testing

Run the Test

- Set the manometer to envelope leakage for CFM50
- Slowly ramp up the fan to depressurize home to **-50** Pascals
- Allow pressure to stabilize
- Record:
    - Indoor/outdoor temp
    - Elevation
    - Baseline pressure
    - CFM at 50 Pascals
    - ACH50

3. Wrap-Up and Reporting

After Test:

- Turn off fan and manometer
- Disassemble blower door and properly store equipment
- Reset HVAC and combustion appliances
- Calculate results: CFM x 60 / VOLUME
- Inform site contact of results (pass/fail, leakage level)

Documentation:

- Upload photos of:
    - Blower door setup
    - Manometer screen with test result
    - Any major leak points
- Enter test results into service fusion

4. Troubleshooting & Notes

- **If the house won't hold pressure:** recheck all exterior openings, look for open vents, fans, chimneys, fixtures, etc.

- **If the client asks about failing:** Offer to do more analysis to find leaks and solutions for client but explain all air sealing will need to be completed and new test scheduled depending on the magnitude of air leaks.

Duct Test

Duct Leakage Testing

Purpose:
To measure air leakage in the duct system using a calibrated duct tester, ensuring compliance with energy code or program-specific requirements (e.g., FORTIFIED, Energy Star).

Applies To:
All field technicians performing duct testing on residential HVAC systems.

1. Preparation Before the Job

Equipment Checklist

- Duct tester with calibrated fan
- Digital manometer (e.g., DG-1000)
- Tubing set
- Fan rings (if needed)
- Flexible duct and collar or grill adapter
- Tape/mastic or grill mask
- Blower door (if DLTO testing is required)

Pre-Visit Tasks

- Confirm address and testing scope (Rough-in or Final)
- Verify if leakage must be tested **to inside or to outside**
- Ask HVAC contractor or builder if the system is ready
- Make sure power is available on-site

Test Type	When Done	Setup Location	Notes
Rough-In Test (No Air Handler)	During HVAC rough-in	At plenum	Ducts must be sealed but may not be connected
Rough-In w/ Air Handler	During HVAC rough-in	At return grill or AHU	Supply and return sealed
Final Test	After drywall & finishes	At main return grill	System must be fully installed

2. Duct Test Types & Requirements Pass thresholds typically:

- **Rough-in:** ≤ 3 CFM25 per 100 sq. ft.
- **Final:** ≤ 4 CFM25 per 100 sq. ft.

3. On-Site Testing Procedure

1. Walkthrough & Setup

- Explain test to site supervisor or HVAC crew
- Verify system is complete (if final) and all registers are accessible
- Close all exterior doors/windows (leave one window open)
- Turn off HVAC system and fans

2. Seal System

- Seal **all supply and return registers** using grill mask or tape or vent cap
- Connect duct tester to main return or AHU using collar or grill plate
- Insert tubing:
    - **Reference tube** into duct system
        - For rough-in test the tube can be inserted through duct mask on register box
        - For test at final the tube can be attached to the port on vent cap or insert through duct mask on supply grille
    - **Fan pressure tube** connected to duct tester
- Power on manometer and zero it

3. Run the Test

- Set fan to pressurize duct system to **+25 Pascals**
- Adjust fan speed until pressure holds steady at 25 Pa
- Record **CFM25 leakage**
- Take a photo of the manometer screen with pressure and CFM showing and a picture of ring size used

4. Interpreting Results & Fails

- If result is **above allowed leakage**:
    - Notify site contact that the duct system **failed**
    - Recommend they **reseal visible leaks**, especially around air handler, boots, or joints
    - Offer to perform a **Duct Leakage to Outside (DLTO)** test to verify leakage path

5. Optional: Duct Leakage to Outside (DLTO) Using Blower Door

When to Use:

- When it's unclear if duct leakage is escaping **to unconditioned space**
- When the total duct leakage fails but the system may still pass DLTO

Procedure:

1. Set up **blower door** to pressurize house to **25 Pascals** during the test
2. Keep **duct blower connected** as usual
3. Configure gauge for leakage to outside test
4. Turn duct blower on and increase speed until gauge indicates **0 Pascals** (equal to outside)
5. The CFM displayed will be the duct leakage to outside
6. Record **CFM25 leakage**
7. Take a photo of the manometer screen with pressure and CFM showing and a picture of ring size used

DLTO often has a different pass threshold (e.g., ≤ 4 CFM25 per 100 sq. ft.)
Always confirm with program requirements.

6. After the Test

- Remove all seals from registers
- Disconnect equipment and reassemble any removed grilles or panels
- Turn HVAC system back on
- Record:
    - Duct leakage CFM
    - House square footage
    - Leakage per 100 sq. ft.

- Upload:
    - Test results
    - Photos of setup and manometer
    - Any notes or fail conditions

Submit results via CompanyCam, Service Fusion, or required portal (e.g., FORTIFIED)

7. Safety & Best Practices

- Don't test with HVAC or exhaust fans running
- Be careful on ladders when sealing ceiling vents
- Never leave the duct tester unattended while running
- Watch for torn duct insulation or visible joint gaps

BLD

SOP: Bank Loan Draw Inspections

Purpose:
To ensure field inspectors capture complete and consistent photo documentation of construction progress so the office team can submit accurate draw requests to lenders.

1. Preparation Before the Visit

- Confirm **project address and borrower/contractor name** in Service Fusion.
- Ensure the phone is charged with CompanyCam access.
- Notify site contact of the arrival window if required by the lender/builder.
- If unable to locate property:
    - Contact the borrower/contractor to verify location and directions to property

2. On-Site Inspection Protocol

1. **Check In**
    - Introduce yourself to site contact (if present).
    - State: *"I'm here to capture photos for the lender's draw inspection."*
2. **Safety First**
    - Enter only safe, accessible areas.
    - Do not move stored materials or climb unsecured ladders.
3. **Photo Documentation – Required Coverage**
    - **Exterior**
        - Each elevation (front, back, left, right)
        - Driveway, garage, landscaping progress, septic, etc.
    - **Interior**
        - Wide shots of each room (living, bedrooms, kitchen, baths, hallways, garage, etc.)
        - Include progress of finishes (flooring, drywall, cabinets, fixtures, paint)
    - **Attic / Mechanical Spaces**
        - Entry photo at attic access
        - Wide shot of attic condition
        - HVAC system, ductwork, water heater, electrical panels (if installed)
    - **Additional Progress Indicators**
        - Stored materials on site (windows, doors, flooring, cabinets, etc.)

        - Close-up shots of notable progress or incomplete areas

Rule of Thumb: Take **too many photos rather than too few**. Multiple angles and close-ups help the office verify % complete.

3. After the Walkthrough

- Make sure all photos upload to **CompanyCam** immediately after the visit.
- Add short notes in ServiceFusion if anything unusual was observed (ex: no power, unsafe access, locked areas).

4. Communication with Office

- Change status in **Service Fusion** to **BLD -** this prompts next steps. Demonstration
- Notify office team if:
    - Access was restricted (locked house, denied entry).
    - Any safety hazard prevented full documentation.
    - A stage of the home was inaccessible (e.g., attic blocked).

Virtual Evaluation

SOP: Conducting a Virtual Evaluation

1. Purpose

This SOP establishes the standardized process for conducting remote (virtual) FORTIFIED Roof evaluations following tear-off and deck nailing. The goal is to ensure compliance with the 2025 FORTIFIED Roof Standard, IBHS documentation requirements, and Knockout Inspections internal quality controls.

All virtual evaluations must be conducted using Zoho Lens. No other video platform is permitted.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

- All Knockout Inspections FORTIFIED Roof evaluations conducted remotely
- Post–tear-off and post–deck-nailing checkpoints
- Evaluators, project managers, and roofers participating in virtual evaluations

This SOP does not replace in-field evaluations when required by scope or jurisdiction.

3. Platform Requirement (Mandatory)

- Zoho Lens is the only approved platform for virtual evaluations
- FaceTime, Zoom, WhatsApp, or similar platforms are not permitted
- All photos, screenshots, and recordings must be captured within Zoho Lens

Any work completed without a Zoho Lens virtual evaluation at required checkpoints may result in loss of FORTIFIED eligibility.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Evaluator

- Lead the Zoho Lens session
- Direct camera positioning and documentation
- Verify compliance with FORTIFIED standards
- Approve work or require corrections
- Ensure all documentation is complete and uploaded

Roofer

- Pause work at required checkpoints
- Join Zoho Lens session as instructed
- Provide clear visual access to all required areas
- Do not proceed until approval is granted

5. Pre-Evaluation Administrative Verification

Before starting the Zoho Lens session, the evaluator must verify:

- Property address
- Homeowner name and contact information
- Party responsible for payment
- FORTIFIED level being pursued (Roof / Silver / Gold)
- Roof sections included in the evaluation
- Roofer FORTIFIED certification
    - Roofer name
    - FORTIFIED Roofer ID number

6. Zoho Lens Session Setup

The evaluator shall:

- Initiate or join the Zoho Lens session
- Confirm correct project name and property address are visible
- Verify live video quality is clear and stable
- Confirm ability to direct camera movement
- Confirm work is paused and underlayment has not been installed

7. Tear-Off Verification

The evaluator shall verify and document:

- Existing roofing materials fully removed in evaluated areas
- Roof deck fully exposed
- No underlayment, peel-and-stick, or synthetic installed
- No concealed repairs or overlays present

8. Roof Deck Condition Review

The evaluator shall verify:

- Deck material type (OSB or plywood)
- Minimum deck thickness of 7/16"
- Deck is dry, clean, and structurally sound
- All damaged or deteriorated sheathing replaced
- Replacement panels properly supported at edges

9. Roof Framing Verification

The evaluator shall verify:

- Framing type (rafters or trusses)
- Framing spacing:
    - 16 inches on center, or
    - 24 inches on center
- Framing is visible and unobstructed
- No unapproved structural modifications are present

10. Deck Attachment Verification (Critical Step)

The evaluator shall confirm:

- Nail type: 8d ring-shank nails
- Nail length provides adequate penetration into framing
- Nail spacing:
    - 4 inches on center at panel edges
    - 4 inches on center in the field

11. Required Zoho Lens Documentation

The evaluator shall capture and save the following within Zoho Lens:

- Wide shots of each roof slope
- Geo-location requested and screenshotted
- Close-ups of field nail spacing
- Nail head and shank visibility
- Deck thickness (where visible)
- Framing spacing verification
- Continuous video sweep of the entire deck surface

12. Roofer Verbal Confirmation

During the Zoho Lens session, the roofer must verbally confirm:

- All deck nailing complies with FORTIFIED requirements
- No underlayment has been installed
- Work will not proceed until evaluator approval is given

13. Evaluation Outcome

Approval

- Evaluator authorizes installation of underlayment
- Approval is documented in job notes

Corrections Required

- Deficiencies are clearly identified
- Required corrections are explained to the roofer
- Corrections are documented
- A follow-up Zoho Lens evaluation is required

15. Documentation and Close-Out

The evaluator shall:

- Complete evaluation notes
- Review Zoho Lens photos and recordings
- Update job status (Approved / Corrections Required)
- Notify roofer of next steps
- Download all photos from Zoho Lens and upload to company cam project.

16. Compliance

Failure to follow this SOP may result in:

- Loss of FORTIFIED eligibility for the project
- Reinspection requirements
- Internal corrective action

Changes Required

Handling FORTIFIED Renewals Blocked by Changes

Purpose: To provide a clear and empathetic process for informing homeowners that their FORTIFIED renewal **cannot be completed** due to changes that violate the program—such as **unverified roof replacements** or **unengineered attached structures**.

1. Field Discovery – What Blocks a Renewal

While on-site, identify any changes made since the original designation that could interfere with renewal.

A. Unverified Roof Replacement

- New roof installed **without evaluator involvement**
- No photo documentation of sealed deck, underlayment, drip edge, etc.
- Roofing contractor did not follow FORTIFIED requirements

B. Attached Structures or Alterations Not Engineered

- New porch, carport, lean-to, patio roof, or overhangs **not engineered or permitted**
- Soffit or gable overhangs modified
- Chimneys removed or altered without documentation
- Any additions that create new load paths or extend beyond the original roofline without structural verification

  FORTIFIED requires that any additions or attached structures **must be engineered** and documented to Gold. If there's no engineering documentation, the home may not be renewed.

2. Document the Issue Thoroughly

Take:

- Wide and close-up photos of all relevant changes
- Photos showing any disconnection between old and new construction
- Screenshots or notes from previous designation (if available)

Write clear field notes describing:

- What changed
- Why it violates FORTIFIED renewal standards
- Whether a potential solution exists (or not)

3. Communicate With the Homeowner

If a window/door was replaced:

> **"Since the door/window was replaced we will need to gather all new Fortified documentation. We will need to find a sticker or invoice that will identify the door and then our team will locate the paperwork. If this information can't be provided the door/window will need to be replaced"**

If the roof was replaced:

> **"It looks like the roof has been replaced since the last FORTIFIED certification, but we weren't involved during installation. Because of that, we don't have the required photo documentation to verify it meets FORTIFIED standards. Unfortunately, a Fortified Roof is the beginning phase of a FORTIFIED Home. Without the documentation the roof would have to be replaced in order to follow the FORTIFIED Process and gather adequate documentation otherwise the home will lose the FORTIFIED Certificate"**

If an attached structure was added or altered:

> **"It looks like a new [porch/carport/overhang] was added. Under FORTIFIED guidelines, any attached structure has to be site specific engineered and tied in a specific way to protect the main structure. Without those documents, we're unable to move forward with renewal."**

Set expectations:

> **"Unfortunately, these changes mean the home is not eligible for renewal right now. That's because the program can't assume the home still meets FORTIFIED Standards without verifying those critical components."**

4. Offer Clear Next Steps

A. If the roof was replaced:

1. Ask who the roofer was
2. Offer to contact the roofer to try and **recover installation photos**
3. If no photos exist → homeowner must **reroof again**

> "If your roofer took pictures during install, we can review those and possibly proceed. If no photos exist, the only way to regain FORTIFIED status is to reroof again—with documentation from start to finish."

B. If an attached structure or alteration is unengineered:

1. Ask if there were **drawings** for the addition
2. Recommend the homeowner speak to a structural engineer to assess and potentially certify the change
3. If not possible → structure may need to be removed or modified

> "If there's no engineering documentation, the addition can't be verified as compliant. In some cases, a structural engineer may be able to provide drawings after the fact, but if not, it could block renewal entirely."

5. Follow-Up Email Templates

Email Template (ROOF REPLACEMENT)

Subject: FORTIFIED Renewal Status & Next Steps

Hi [Homeowner Name],

Thanks again for your time today. After completing the site visit, I discovered that your property is currently not eligible for FORTIFIED renewal due to the following:

- The roof was replaced without documentation verifying compliance with FORTIFIED installation requirements

To move forward, here are your options:

1. If your roofer has installation photos (deck nailing, underlayment, flashing), we may be able to use those for verification.

2. If documentation cannot be recovered, the only way to regain a FORTIFIED designation would be through a new roof installation.

Let me know how you'd like to proceed. I'm happy to help guide you through it.

Best regards,
Knockout Inspections

Email Template (ATTACHED STRUCTURE)

Hi (Homeowner Name),

Thanks again for your time today. After reviewing the photos, I discovered that your property is currently not eligible for FORTIFIED renewal due to the following:

-An attached structure ([porch/carport/overhang]) was added or altered without engineering documentation

To move forward, here are the options:
-Downgrade the designation to a Fortified ROOF if we can document that the structure does not tie into the main structure and there is clear separation.

-1) Consult with the installing contractor to see if they potentially have structural plans for the addition 2) Consult with an engineer to provide a site specific engineer letter to verify Gold Fortified compliance.

Regardless of whether or not the contractor is able to provide plans we will have to have an engineer provide a site specific letter in order to ATTEMPT to keep the designation at the Gold level if that is what you would like to do.

Unfortunately, at this time, there are no clear instructions on retrofitting these structures to meet the IBHS FORTIFIED Standard. Everything I have suggested is based on past attempts -- some of which were approved and others rejected. Please note, there will also be additional charges for the engineer's letter. I want to make sure you have all the information needed to weigh your options and understand that we cannot guarantee approval.

Email Template (DOOR REPLACEMENT)

Hi (Homeowner Name),

Thanks again for your time today. After reviewing the photos, I discovered that your property is currently not eligible for FORTIFIED renewal due to the following:

-An exterior door was changed without proper documentation.

To move forward here are the options:

1. Check door for stickers/markings to identify manufacturer and type of door
2. Check with supplier for site specific invoice with door information
3. Replace the exterior door and follow FORTIFIED process of documenting all paperwork, stickers and invoices to identify door and test data
4. Downgrade the certificate to a Silver if the opening has impact rating separate from door assembly (fabric shield anchors)

Let me know how you would like to proceed. I'm happy to help guide you through it.

Best Regards,
Knockout Inspections

EMAIL TEMPLATE (ADDITION IN PROGRESS)

Hello,

Thanks again for your time today. After reviewing the photos, like we discussed, your property would not be eligible for FORTIFIED Renewal due to the following:

-An attached structure is being added to the home.

To move forward and keep your Gold Designation here is what would need to be done:

We would need to consult with you and the contractor to get an idea of the scope of the work so we can better assess what items would need to be addressed for FORTIFIED. There is almost always a requirement for stamped engineer plans when an attached structure is added to a Gold home so that would be one part that we would want to address first.

Depending on the scope of the work there will be other requirements that we will address after we have had a discussion. You must work with a Fortified Evaluator in order to achieve keeping the designation. I do suggest holding off on any work to ensure that nothing is altered/changed that could affect the certification. There will be the risk of losing your entire Fortified Certificate if work proceeds as is without the proper protocol.

Let me know if you have any questions and feel free to reach out to me at any time.

6. Internal Workflow

1. Contact homeowner to notify and discuss changes made
2. Inform homeowners of the options they have to keep certification level, downgrade or if they risk losing certification all together.
    - Door/window changed with identification: Identify door type/manufacturer and locate test data. (Test data can be internally researched)
    - Door/window changed with no identification: Replace the window/door or downgrade to a Silver level if opening has fabric shield impact protection.
    - Attached structure: Site specific engineering/photos of all connections. An engineer letter is sometimes needed as well.
3. Use an email template to send to the homeowner everything that was discussed for their evaluation. (Send through Service Fusion so we have a trace of the conversation)
4. Set a task on your schedule to follow up with the homeowner a week from the time of initial conversation.
5. Schedule any follow up visits needed to assist the homeowner.

Remote Fortified Jobs

SOP: Remote FORTIFIED Jobs – Pre-Verification & Coordination

For Use By: Knockout Inspections – Evaluators / Office Team

Purpose: To confirm all requirements for remote or long-distance FORTIFIED evaluations before scheduling, preventing wasted trips and ensuring eligibility.

1. Initial Client Intake

- Confirm **type of job** (Roof, Silver, Gold).
- Confirm **address and distance** from office.
- Explain **fees**, including any travel surcharge.

2. Critical Verification (Must Be Confirmed Before Scheduling)

A. Roofer Certification

- Verify the roofer is **FORTIFIED-certified**.
- Request roofer's certification number or confirm in IBHS directory.
- If **not certified**:
    - Stop scheduling.
    - Inform homeowner/roofer the designation **cannot proceed** until this requirement is met.

B. Insurance Involvement

- Ask: *"Is this roof being paid for by insurance?"*
- If yes:
    - Document carrier and adjuster info.

    - Ask about claim deadlines (important for scheduling).
    - **FORTIFIED Supplement Check**
        - If retrofits are required (deck nailing, sealed roof deck, etc.):
            - The homeowner/roofer must confirm **the insurance supplement covers these items**.
            - Verify with the homeowner/roofer that proceeding with FORTIFIED will **not void or reduce** the approved supplement.
            - If supplement does not allow for retrofits → **designation cannot move forward** until resolved.

C. Structural Verification – Photo Proof Required

Request clear photos showing:

- **Roof deck thickness** (exposed decking or manufacturer stamp).
- **Foundation** (slab, piers, or crawlspace).
- **Exterior elevations** (wide shots of all four sides).
- **Rafter spacing** (attic photos showing spacing, typically 16" or 24" OC).

If these cannot be provided → **do not schedule** until the homeowner/roofer submits them.

3. Internal Review Before Approval

- The evaluator reviews all submitted photos and documents.
- Confirm each requirement is satisfied:
    - Roofer certified
    - Insurance info documented (if applicable)
    - **FORTIFIED supplement confirmed (if insurance involved)**
    - Structural photos verified (deck, foundation, elevations, rafters)
- If complete → approve scheduling.
- If not → provide the homeowner with a clear list of missing items.

4. Red Flags – Do Not Schedule Until Resolved

- Roofer not FORTIFIED-certified
- No proof of **deck thickness**
- No proof of **rafter spacing**
- No **foundation or elevation photos**
- Insurance supplement does **not** cover required retrofits

Setting up CompanyCam

Setting Up CompanyCam

Purpose: To ensure all new users correctly set up CompanyCam on their mobile devices so project photos include required geotagging and timestamps.

Scope: This SOP applies to all new employees who will use CompanyCam for project documentation.

1. Responsibilities

- New Employee – Download, log in, and configure app settings correctly.
- Supervisor/Trainer – Verify setup is complete before first field assignment.

2. Procedure

A. Download the App

1. Open the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play Store (Android).
2. Search for CompanyCam.
3. Download and install the app.

B. Log In

1. Open the CompanyCam app.
2. Select Log In.
3. Enter your company email address or credentials provided by the office.
4. If prompted, verify your account through the company email system.

C. Enable Geotag and Time/Date Stamp in CompanyCam

1. Open the CompanyCam app.
2. Tap My Stuff at the bottom right.
3. Tap the Settings gear icon at the top right.

4. Select Camera.
5. Scroll down to the More section.
6. Toggle ON both:
    - Stamp date and time
    - Stamp GPS coordinates
7. Video walkthrough: 🎬 Setting up CompanyCam.mp4

D. Verification

1. Take a test photo inside the CompanyCam app.
2. Open the photo and confirm:
    - The date and time are stamped.
    - The GPS coordinates are stamped.
3. Notify your supervisor once complete.

3. Compliance

- Employees may not use CompanyCam until setup is verified.
- Incorrect setup (missing geotag or timestamp) can delay projects and may require retraining.

Using CompanyCam

SOP: CompanyCam Revamp

Purpose

We are implementing a new standardized workflow in CompanyCam to streamline site visits, reduce confusion, and ensure consistent documentation across all projects.

The goal is simple:
Field Technicians should not need to create anything manually.
Your project will already be set up — you only need to locate it and complete the required tasks.

What's Changing (High Level)

We are building **Project Templates** that will automatically:

- Create the project for you
- Assign the correct checklist (To-Dos)
- Provide SOP guidance for the visit type
- Include agreements, bulletins, and reference materials
- Standardize photo organization and documentation

This removes guesswork and ensures every job is completed consistently.

What You Need To Do in the Field

When you arrive at a job:

1. Open CompanyCam.
2. Search the **property address**.
3. Open the project that has already been created for you.
4. Complete the assigned To-Dos and upload photos as instructed.

That's it. No setup required.

Understanding the Project Structure

Each project will contain key sections located on the **Project Home Page**.

1. To-Dos → Your Checklists

This is the most important section for field work.

Here you will find:

- Required photo checklists
- Site visit tasks
- Any action items specific to the job

Think of this as your **step-by-step instructions** for the visit.

Always complete To-Dos before leaving the site.

2. Documents Tab → Pages & Files

Both **Pages** and **Files** live under the **Documents** tab on the Project Home Page.

This is where you will find all supporting information for the job.

Pages → SOPs & Instructions

Pages contain guidance for the type of service you are performing.

Examples include:

- Site visit standard operating procedures
- Special inspection instructions

If you are unsure how to perform something, check Pages first.

Files → Agreements & Technical Resources

Files store important reference materials such as:

- Signed agreements
- Compliance forms
- Technical bulletins
- Installation guidance documents

- Educational resources for homeowners or roofers

This section helps you answer questions in the field and ensures everyone is working from the same information.

3. Photos → Documentation

Photos should be uploaded directly to the project.

Follow:

- The checklist requirements in To-Dos
- All photos are have geotag and time stamp activated

Consistent documentation improves QA speed and reduces callbacks.

Why This Matters

This new system will:

- Reduce time spent figuring out what to do
- Prevent missed documentation
- Improve quality and consistency
- Speed up application processing
- Make training easier for new evaluators
- Reduce back-and-forth communication

Ultimately, it allows you to focus on the evaluation — not the logistics.

Expectations

All evaluators are expected to:

- Use the assigned project (do not create new ones unless instructed)
- Complete all To-Dos before leaving site
- Review Pages when unsure about procedures
- Upload photos in real time when possible
- Communicate issues immediately if something is missing

Support

If you cannot find a project or something appears incorrect:

Contact the office before proceeding.

Remote Roof Evaluations

SOP: Conducting Remote FORTIFIED Jobs

Purpose

To establish a clear and verifiable process for completing FORTIFIED evaluations remotely while maintaining the same level of quality, accuracy, and integrity as in-person site visits. This ensures that all documentation, verification, and communication meet IBHS program standards.

Scope

This procedure applies to all Knockout evaluators and roofing partners participating in remote FORTIFIED projects.

Procedure

1. Roofer Onboarding and Training

- Before any remote project begins, all participating roofers must complete an **onboarding call** with a Knockout representative.
- During this session, Knockout will review:
    - FORTIFIED Roof program requirements
    - Required documentation and photo standards
    - Remote verification procedures
    - Common mistakes and best practices
- Roofers must complete a **short comprehension exam** after training to confirm they understand Knockout's remote documentation process, quality expectations, and submission requirements.
- Roofers must provide proof of being **FORTIFIED Certified** through IBHS before being approved to work on remote FORTIFIED projects.
- Roofers must acknowledge their understanding and sign agreement to follow Knockout's documentation and verification procedures before being approved for remote collaboration.

2. Project Setup

- Each project will be created in the designated Knockout project management platform.
- The project must include:
    - Homeowner's name and correct address
    - Roofer contact information
    - Roofer Fortified ID number
    - Project type
    - Any applicable checklists, documentation templates, or upload folders
- All photo and video documentation will be uploaded and stored in the designated project file for internal review.
- Prior to conducting any remote evaluation, the **homeowner must sign an agreement or consent form authorizing the use of virtual evaluations for the project**. This agreement confirms that the homeowner understands that portions of the FORTIFIED evaluation process will be conducted remotely through photo documentation and live virtual verification.

3. Verification and Virtual Evaluations

Two remote evaluation sessions will be conducted for each job:

A. Mid-Install Virtual Evaluation

- Conducted during the underlayment or deck sealing phase.
- Roofers must connect with Knockout via a **geolocation-verified video call**.
- Evaluator will:
    - Confirm the roofer's location matches the project address
    - Direct live video capture of all key installation components
    - Take live screenshots for documentation
    - Confirm materials used match those specified in documentation

B. Final Virtual Evaluation

- Conducted once installation is complete, **but not necessarily on the same day**.
- The evaluation must occur **before submission to IBHS** to verify the completed roof condition.
- Roofer will connect via a geolocation-verified video call for the evaluation.
- Evaluator will:
    - Confirm project address and GPS location again
    - Review the completed installation and take live screenshots as needed
    - Verify that all required photos and documents have been uploaded

    - Address any missing documentation or unclear images prior to final approval

4. Quality Control and Fraud Prevention

To ensure authenticity, accuracy, and completeness of all remote documentation:

- All photos must retain **embedded metadata (EXIF)** including GPS coordinates, date, and time.
- Roofers are required to complete **documentation checklists** for every project.
    - Each checklist must include **supporting photos for every line item** to confirm accuracy and completeness.
    - Checklists will include **both technical information** (material specs, fastener spacing, underlayment type, etc.) and **practical expectations** (clarity, coverage, and quality of submitted photos).
- Any discrepancies or missing metadata will trigger a **photo verification review** before submission.
- We will only accept geotag for site specific documentation. Address post cards are **not** acceptable.
- Remote evaluators will use internal verification checklists to confirm consistency across projects.

5. Support and Communication

- Knockout will host **weekly office hours** for all participating roofers to ask questions, review documentation standards, or receive feedback.
- Evaluators and roofers are encouraged to maintain open communication throughout the project to ensure quality and compliance.

6. Documentation and Submission

- Once the project has passed final verification, the evaluator will compile all documentation for submission to IBHS following standard FORTIFIED reporting guidelines.
- Any missing or unclear documentation will be returned to the roofer for correction prior to submission.